// STUDY NOTES · ENGLISH EDITION

Top 40 QA Interview Questions

A free checklist from AllTestsPassed — the questions testers really get asked, from Junior to Senior, manual and automation.



Test suite contents

Ten questions per level. Answer each one out loud — if you can, it's passed.

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TEST CASES	STATUS
5	PASSED

README.md

This free guide collects 40 real interview questions from the AllTestsPassed study notes. Use it as a checklist: if you can answer a question out loud in one or two minutes, mark it as passed. Every answer is explained in detail in the full notes — see the last page. **You are welcome to share this PDF.**

TC-01 Junior QA Interview Questions

✓ PASSED

01 What is software testing and why do we test? Name the seven testing principles.

02 What is the difference between QA, QC and testing?

03 Describe the SDLC and the STLC. Where does testing start?

04 What fields does a good bug report have? Give an example of a good bug title.

05 Explain severity and priority with examples of high/low combinations.

06 Walk through the defect life cycle. What do you do if a developer rejects your bug?

07 Name the test levels and the main types of testing (functional, non-functional, regression, smoke, sanity).

08 Apply equivalence partitioning and boundary value analysis to an "age 18–30" field.

09 What do 2xx, 4xx and 5xx HTTP status codes mean?

10 How would you test a login form?

TIP

For any "how would you test..." question, structure the answer: clarify requirements → positive checks → negative checks → boundary values → non-functional checks (UI, performance, security).

TC-02 Middle QA Interview Questions

✓ PASSED

01 How do you decide what to test first when there is not enough time?

02 How do you estimate testing for a new feature? Name at least two techniques.

03 How do you build and maintain a regression suite?

04 What is the difference between 401 and 403? Between PUT and PATCH? What does idempotent mean?

05 Write a SQL query: customers without orders; duplicate emails.

06 What is a flaky test and how do you deal with it?

07 How do you find out whether a bug is on the frontend or the backend?

08 What metrics would you include in a test summary report?

09 What is the difference between load, stress and soak testing? Why use percentiles?

10 Name a few OWASP Top 10 risks and how you would check for them.

TC-03 Junior Automation QA Interview Questions

✓ PASSED

01 What should and should not be automated? Explain the test automation pyramid.

02 Which locator types do you know? Which do you prefer and why?

03 What is the difference between implicit, explicit and fluent waits? Why is `sleep` bad?

04 What is auto-waiting in Playwright?

05 What is a Page Object and why do we use it?

06 Explain the four OOP principles with examples from test code.

07 What is the difference between hard and soft assertions?

08 How do you make tests independent from each other?

09 A test passes locally but fails in CI. What do you check?

10 How do you keep passwords and tokens out of the repository?

TC-04 Senior QA and SDET Interview Questions

✓ PASSED

01 You join a product with no testing process and frequent production bugs. What do you do in the first 30/60/90 days?

02 How would you design a test strategy for a microservices-based platform?

03 How do you decide the right balance between unit, API and UI tests?

04 The E2E suite takes 3 hours and 10% of tests are flaky. How do you fix this?

05 What are contract tests and when would you introduce them?

06 How do you test an asynchronous, event-driven flow?

07 How do you calculate and present the ROI of automation to management?

08 A release date is fixed but critical bugs are still open. How do you handle it?

09 Which quality metrics would you show to a CTO? Which would you avoid?

10 How do you mentor a junior tester and give difficult feedback?

TC-05 Want the Answers? ✓ PASSED

Every question above is explained in detail — with examples, diagrams and code — in the full AllTestsPassed study notes:

- **Junior, Middle, Senior Software Tester** and **QA Lead** — manual QA notes
- **Junior, Middle, Senior Automation QA** — Playwright, API, CI/CD, frameworks
- **From Junior to Senior** and the **General QA Handbook** — bundles with everything in one PDF

EXAMPLE

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Thank you!

All tests passed.

I hope these notes help you in your next interview and in your everyday work as a tester.

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